



Technical Writing:

How to Write Using DITA XML

JORDAN STANCHEV

About This Course

- ▶ DITA XML knowledge for technical writers. All meetings will be recorded and provided to you as a reference.
- ▶ Hands-on with Oxygen XML Author tool.
- ▶ A project you must submit to be graded and receive personalized feedback from the instructor.
- ▶ My email: jordan.stanchev@jpdocu.com

Course Instructor



Jordan Stanchev

Works as a Product Manager of the DITA XML authoring environment at SAP SE.

Certified Project Management Professional (PMP) with more than 20 years of experience in the field of technical communications.

As a part of JPDocu School of Technical Writing has been delivering courses on technical writing, information architecture, and DITA XML to students around the world.

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About This Course

Course Curriculum:

Section 1: Introduction

Section 2: Get Started with DITA

Section 3: DITA Elements

Section 4: Reusing Content in DITA

Section 5: Profiling (conditioning) content in DITA

Section 6: Information Architecture for Technical Communicators

Section 7: Information Architecture for DITA Authors

Section 8: How to Create Interactive Images

Section 9: Linking Strategies



What is DITA?

What is DITA?

DITA stands for *Darwin Information Typing Architecture (DITA)*

DITA is an XML data model. You use it for authoring and publishing purposes.

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 - 1.5 [Formatting conventions in the XHTML version of the specification](#)
 - 1.6 [Formatting conventions in the Errata 02 version of the specification](#)
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 - 2.1.4 [Producing different deliverables from a single source](#)
 - 2.2 [DITA markup](#)
 - 2.2.1 [DITA topics](#)
 - 2.2.1.1 [The topic as the basic unit of information](#)
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 - 2.2.1.3 [Disciplined, topic-oriented writing](#)
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 - 2.2.1.5 [Generic topics](#)
 - 2.2.1.6 [Topic structure](#)
 - 2.2.1.7 [Topic content](#)
 - 2.2.2 [DITA maps](#)
 - 2.2.2.1 [Definition of DITA maps](#)
 - 2.2.2.2 [Purpose of DITA maps](#)
 - 2.2.2.3 [DITA map elements](#)
 - 2.2.2.4 [DITA map attributes](#)
 - 2.2.2.5 [Examples of DITA maps](#)

Who Defines What is DITA?

OASIS Darwin Information Typing Architecture (DITA) Technical Committee

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OASIS Darwin Information Typing Architecture (DITA) TC

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Advancing a document creation and management specification that builds content reuse into the authoring process

Kristen Eberlein, kris@eberleinconsulting.com, Chair
Nancy Harrison, nharrison@infobridge-solutions.com, Secretary

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Announcements

[OASIS Launches New DITA XML.org Technical Publishing Community Portal](#): New Web Site Sponsored by Adobe, Congility, and IBM Brings DITA Users Together to Share Information; 23 April 2018.

DITA version 1.3 was approved as an OASIS Standard. Review [details about the new version](#) and download links. See the [press release](#) with executive endorsements from Adobe, Cisco, Comtech, IBM, ISIS Papyrus, IXIASOFT, Oracle, PTC, and SDL.

Related links

- [Charter](#)
- [IPR Statement](#)
- [FAQ](#)
- [Membership](#)
- [Obligated Members](#)
- [Email Archives](#)
- [Comments Archive](#)
- [Ballots](#)
- [Documents](#)
- [Schedule](#)
- [Press](#)

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- [Cisco Systems](#)
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- [Microsoft](#)
- [Oracle](#)
- [SAP SE](#)
- [SDL](#)
- [Software AG](#)
- [US Department of Defense \(DoD\)](#)

DITA Specification

Link to the DITA 1.3 Specification:

<http://docs.oasis-open.org/dita/dita/v1.3/errata02/os/complete/part0-overview/introduction/about-the-dita-specification.html#about-the-dita-specification>
[n](#)

Link to the DITA Base Edition

<http://docs.oasis-open.org/dita/dita/v1.3/errata02/os/complete/part1-base/dita-v1.3-errata02-os-part1-base-complete.html>



Benefits from Writing Using DITA XML

Benefits from Writing Using DITA XML

DITA XML is the de-facto XML standard for writing software documentation. There are many DITA Content Management System (CMS) vendors that you can choose from, as it is a standard XML to learn and manage.



Benefits from Writing Using DITA XML

Learn DITA XML once and you can work at any company that uses DITA for its documentation development.



Single-sourced output: DITA allows you to focus on the content; the production is separated and you can produce in multiple output formats. You can use the free open source Open Tool Kit (OTK) to transform your DITA XML into output format you require (HTML, PDF, ePub, Markdown, etc).



Benefits from Writing Using DITA XML

DITA XML allows you to scale work over large documentation deliverables (literally, thousands of pages long documents).



Benefits from Writing Using DITA XML

DITA XML can be specialized or generalized for easier use across vendors or companies.



Benefits from Writing Using DITA XML

DITA XML allows you to define the set of elements you want to use within a topic, even for your own, unique topic templates.



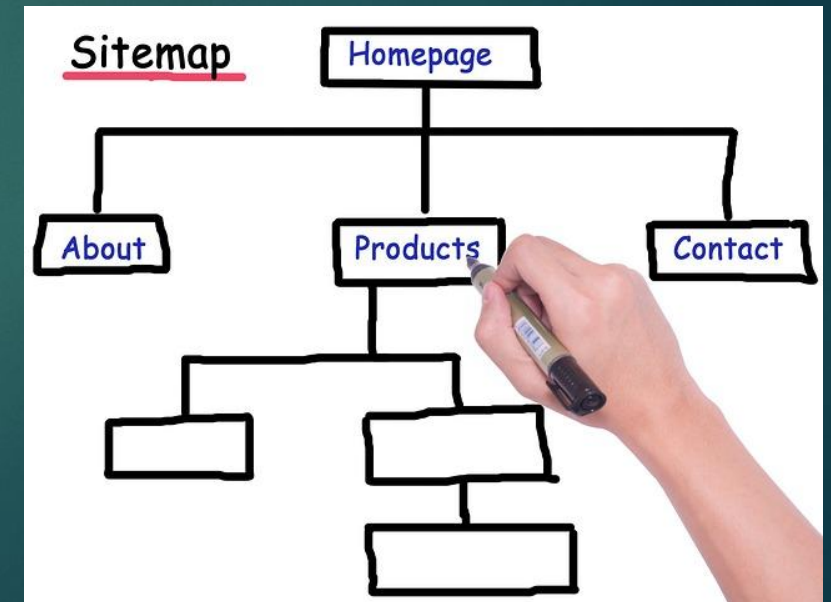
Benefits from Writing Using DITA XML

DITA XML supports filtering and flagging, and this way, personalization of the generated output, by the use of profiling (conditioning) attributes on maps, topics, topic elements.



Benefits from Writing Using DITA XML

DITA XML is a semantic language, meaning each tag has a predefined meaning. As a result, DITA XML allows high level of processes automation, such as special formatting of topic elements, automatic links generation, classification of topics with metadata for filtering and flagging of content based on rules, etc.

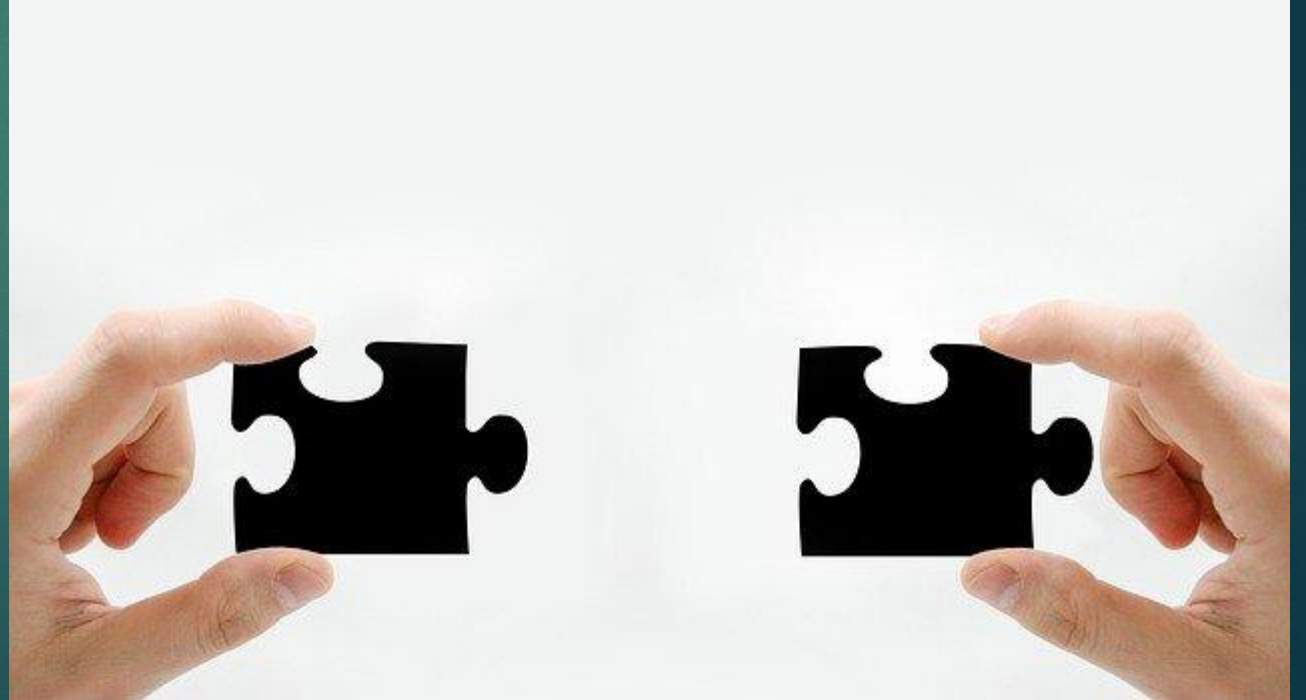




What's
Needed to
Support the
Benefits?

Authoring in DITA

Based on information types – (e.g. Task, Concept, Reference)



Authoring in DITA

Deliverables structure is organized outside the topic – via maps



Authoring in DITA

Implies that the author shall follow strict rules for writing



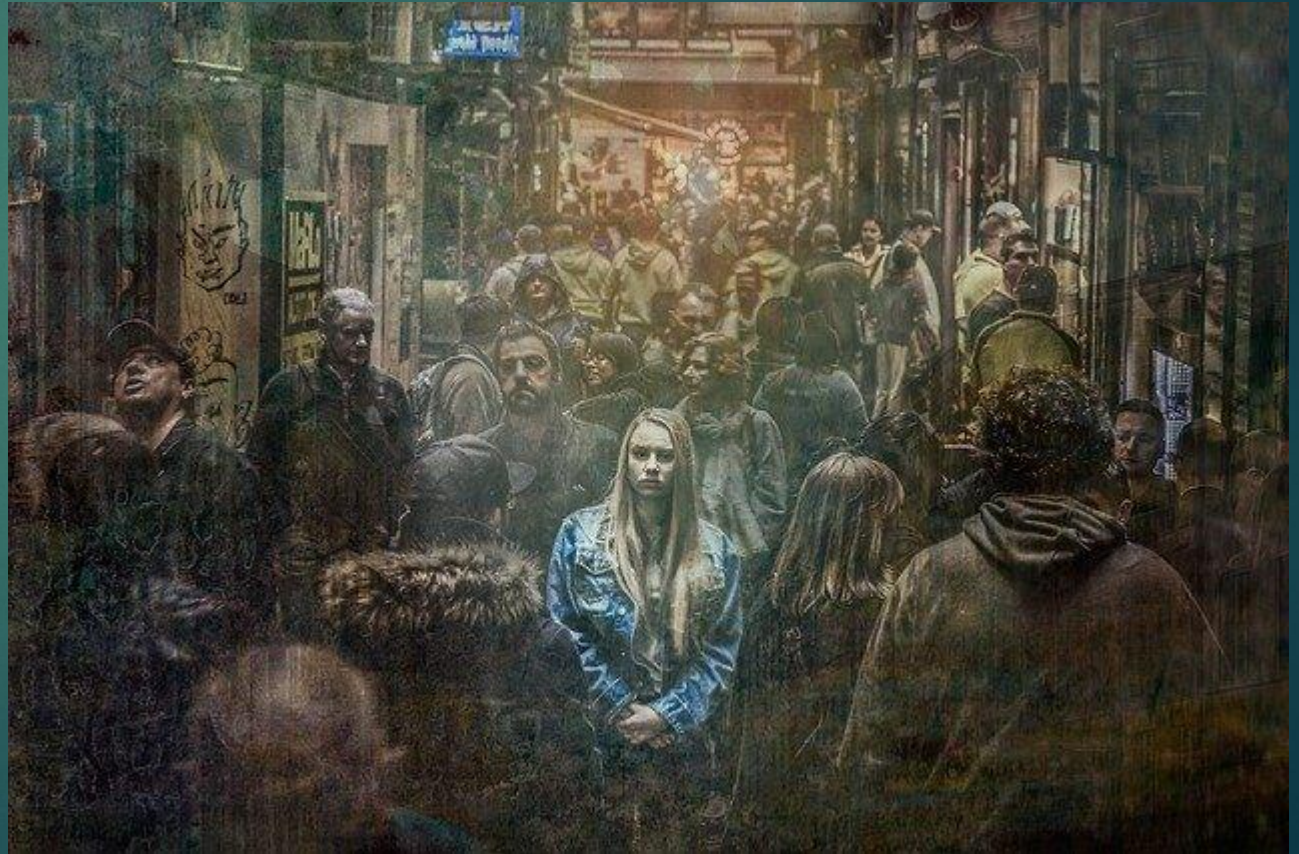
Authoring in DITA

Modularized and reusable



Authoring in DITA

Context-free





Information Architecture Requirements in DITA

Information Architecture in DITA

Different levels of content reuse – deliverable, map, topic, topic element



Information Architecture in DITA

Enables the development of linking strategy – across deliverables, between maps, between topics; automatically generated links or manually inserted links



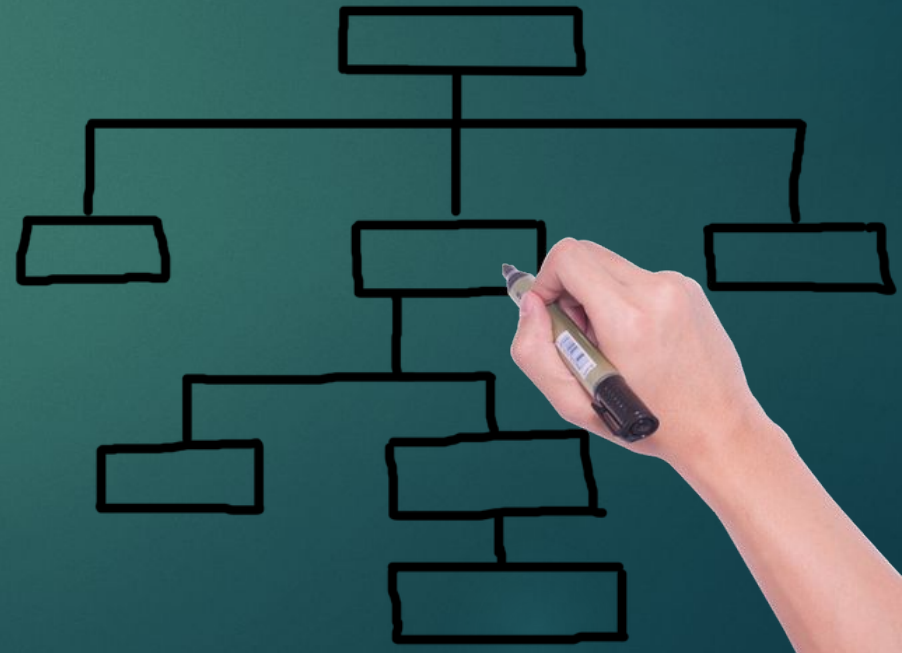
Information Architecture in DITA

Filtering and flagging of the final deliverable, based on profiling values (conditions)



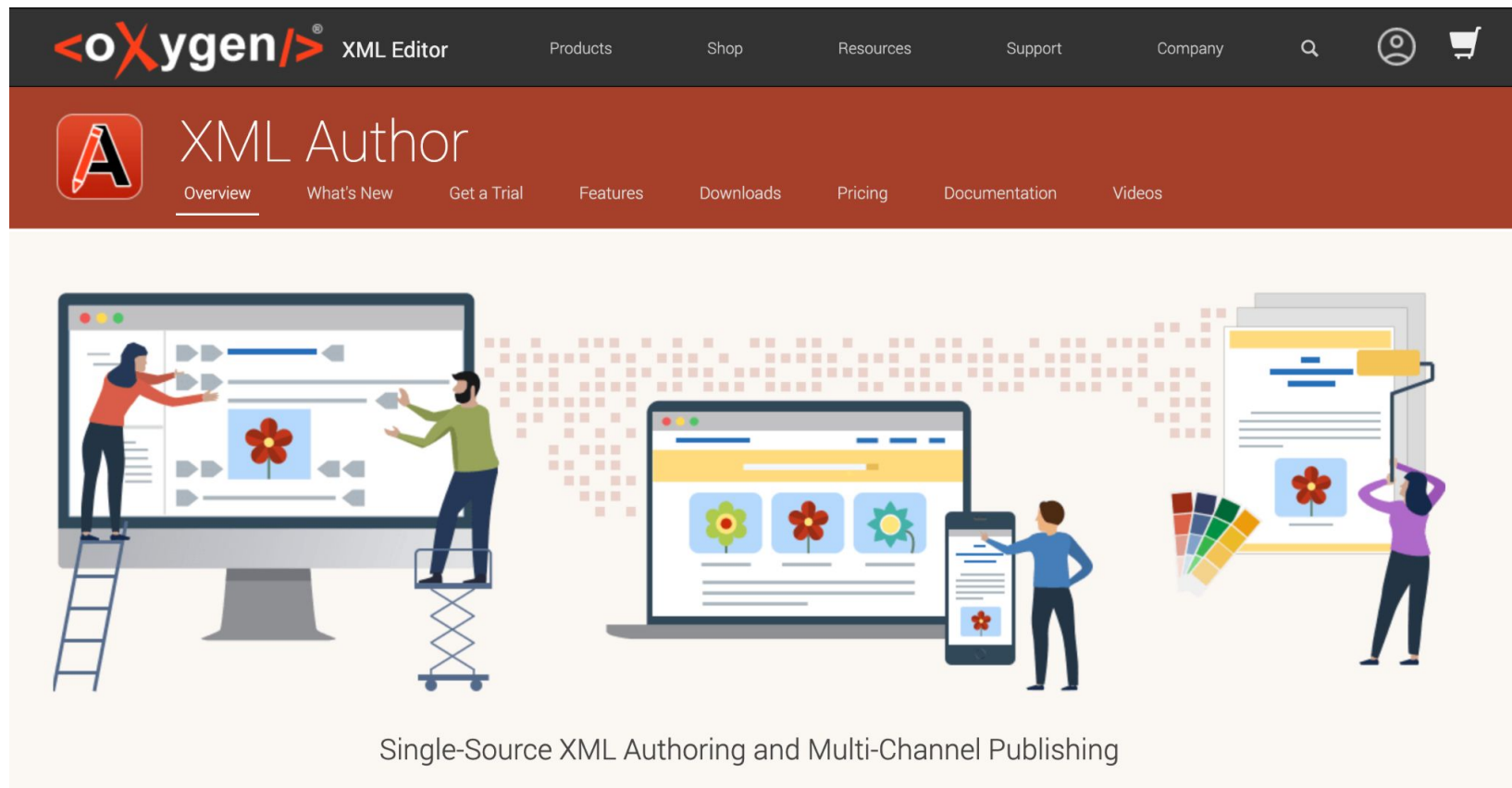
Information Architecture in DITA

Construct taxonomies for the purpose of constructing controlled vocabularies or define new classification subjects (metadata) for your content.





How to Get Started with DITA?



Use an editor of choice. in this course, we use Oxygen
XML Author:

[HTTPS://WWW.OXYGENXML.COM](https://www.oxygenxml.com)

Install the Software

1. Request a trial license from the Get a Trial page:
https://www.oxygenxml.com/xml_author/register.html?p=author
2. Start the download. Go to
https://www.oxygenxml.com/xml_author/download_oxygenxml_author.html
3. Choose your OS.
4. Click on the *Download* button.
5. Once the download is complete, start the installation wizard and install the tool.
6. Once the installation is complete, enter your trial license key.
You are now ready with the setup of the software for this course.